

2022-23 - FIRST SEMESTER
FINANCIAL TIME SERIES (SFA01)
MASTER 2, PRINCIPAL SESSION

Written exam of January 26, 2023

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Durée: 2 heures.

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Exercise 1. Let us consider a time series $\vec{Y} = ((Y_t(k))_{1 \leq k \leq m})_{t \in \mathbb{Z}}$ valued in $\mathbb{R}^m$, defined by

$$Y(k) = F_{\psi^{(k)}}(X) + \sigma \epsilon(k), \quad k = 1, \dots, m,$$

where $\sigma > 0$ and

- (i) $X = (X_t)_{t \in \mathbb{Z}}$ is a centered time series valued in $\mathbb{R}$ with spectral density function f^X ;
- (ii) $\psi^{(k)} = (\psi_t^{(k)})_{t \in \mathbb{Z}} \in \ell^1(\mathbb{Z})$ and $F_{\psi^{(k)}}$ is the associated convolutional filter defined by

$$\left[F_{\psi^{(k)}}(X) \right]_t = \sum_{s \in \mathbb{Z}} \psi_s^{(k)} X_{t-s}, \quad t \in \mathbb{Z};$$

- (iii) $\vec{\epsilon} = ((\epsilon_t(k))_{1 \leq k \leq m})_{t \in \mathbb{Z}} \sim \text{WN}(0, \Sigma)$ is a centered white noise process valued in $\mathbb{R}^m$ with covariance matrix Σ , uncorrelated with X . We assume moreover that Σ is positive definite (hence invertible).

1. Give the spectral density matrix function of $\vec{\epsilon}$.
2. Give, for $k = 1, \dots, m$, the spectral density function of $F_{\psi^{(k)}}(X)$ using the Fourier series functions

$$\psi^{(k)*}(\lambda) = \sum_{t \in \mathbb{Z}} \psi_t^{(k)} e^{-i\lambda t}, \quad k = 1, \dots, m, \lambda \in \mathbb{R}.$$

3. Show that the spectral density matrix function M of $\vec{Y}$ reads

$$M(\lambda) = f^X(\lambda) \vec{a}(\lambda) \vec{a}(\lambda)^H + A,$$

where $\vec{a}(\lambda)$ is a vector of $\mathbb{C}^m$ and A is a $m \times m$ matrix, and determine $\vec{a}(\lambda)$ and A .

4. Deduce the coherence function $C_{k,l} = |M_{k,l}| / \sqrt{M_{k,k} M_{l,l}}$ for all $1 \leq k < l \leq m$.
5. What is the behavior of $C_{k,l}(\lambda)$ as $\sigma \rightarrow 0$? Express the result using the frequency sets defined by

$$\Lambda := \{\lambda : f^X(\lambda) \neq 0\}$$

and, for $k = 1, \dots, m$ by

$$\Lambda_k = \{\lambda : \psi^{(k)*}(\lambda) \neq 0\},$$

From now on, we assume that $\sigma = 1$ and $f^X(\lambda) = 1/(2\pi)$ for all λ . We denote by B the backshift operator.

6. Give M and $C_{k,l}$ if, moreover, for all $k = 1, \dots, m$, $F_{\psi^{(k)}} = B^{\tau_k}$ for some $\tau_k \in \mathbb{Z}$?

From now on, we moreover assume that, for all $k = 1, \dots, m$,

$$\psi^{(k)*}(\lambda) = \frac{\Theta_k(e^{-i\lambda})}{\Phi_k(e^{-i\lambda})},$$

where Θ_k and Φ_k are coprime polynomials with real coefficients such that $\Theta_k(0) = \Phi_k(0) = 1$.

7. What can we say about the process $F_{\psi^{(k)}}(X)$ for $k = 1, \dots, m$?
8. Show that the process $\vec{Y}$ is a VARMA process. [**Hint:** use that a weakly stationary vector process $\vec{Z} = (\vec{Z}_t)_{t \in \mathbb{Z}}$ such that $\text{Cov}(Z_s, Z_t) = 0$ for $|t - s| > q$ is a VMA(q) process.]
9. Let Φ be the lowest common multiple of $\Phi_1, \dots, \Phi_m$. Show that, for all $\vec{x} \in \mathbb{R}^m$, $\Phi(B)\vec{x}^T \vec{Y}$ is an MA process.

Exercise 2. Let X and Y be two jointly $\mathcal{N}(0, 1)$ random variables and define $\alpha = \text{Cov}(X, Y)$. We recall that two variables X and Y are said to be jointly Gaussian if (X, Y) is a Gaussian vector.

10. Show that $\alpha \in [-1, 1]$ and give the mean and the covariance matrix of the $\mathbb{R}^2$ -valued vector (X, Y) .
11. Show that $\text{Cov}(Y^2, Y) = 0$ and $\text{Var}(Y^2) = 2$.
12. Determine $\hat{X} = \text{proj}(X | \text{Span}(Y))$, and, setting $\epsilon = X - \hat{X}$, show that ϵ and Y are independent. Deduce that $\text{Cov}(X^2, Y^2) = 2\alpha^2$.
13. Deduce that for two centered jointly Gaussian variables Z_1 and Z_2 , we have

$$\text{Cov}(Z_1^2, Z_2^2) = 2(\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2))^2.$$

14. Conclude that, for four centered jointly Gaussian variables $Z_1, \dots, Z_4$, we have

$$\text{Cov}(Z_1 Z_3, Z_2 Z_4) = \text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2) \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_4) + \text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_4) \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2).$$

[**Hint:** use the identity $ab = \frac{1}{4}((a+b)^2 - (a-b)^2)$.]

Let us now consider a real valued and centered Gaussian process $(Z_t)_{t \in \mathbb{Z}}$ with autocovariance function γ . We assume that it admits a spectral density function f in $L^2(\mathbb{T}, \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{T}))$, which implies that

$$\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma^2(k) = 2\pi \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f^2(\lambda) d\lambda < \infty.$$

Let us define

$$\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_t Z_{t+|h|} \text{ if } |h| < n \text{ and } \tilde{\gamma}_n(h) = 0 \text{ otherwise,} \quad (1)$$

seen as an estimator of $\gamma(h)$ from $Z_1, \dots, Z_n$.

15. Compute the bias $b(h) = \mathbb{E}[\tilde{\gamma}_n(h)] - \gamma(h)$ for all $h \in \mathbb{Z}$.

16. Show that, for all $h \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\text{Var}(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h)) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (1 - (|h| + |k|)/n)_+ [\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k+h)\gamma(k-h)] ,$$

where $a_+ = \max(a, 0)$.

17. Derive the limit

$$\ell(h) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} n \mathbb{E} [(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2] .$$

and express $\ell(h)$ using f .

We now further assume that

$$\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma(k) < \infty ,$$

and we suppose that we observe $U_t = Z_t + \mu$, $t = 1, \dots, n$, with $\mu \in \mathbb{R}$ unknown and we denote the usual empirical covariance estimator by

$$\hat{\gamma}_n(h) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} (U_t - \hat{\mu}_n)(U_{t+|h|} - \hat{\mu}_n) \text{ if } |h| < n \text{ and } \hat{\gamma}_n(h) = 0 \text{ otherwise ,}$$

where $\hat{\mu}_n = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1}^n U_k$. We set for any $\tau \geq 0$, $m_n(\tau) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1+\tau}^{n-\tau} Z_k$.

18. For $h \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $n > 2|h|$, express $\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \tilde{\gamma}_n(h)$ using $m_n(0)$ and $m_n(|h|)$.

19. Let $\tau \in \mathbb{N}$, what is the limit of $n \mathbb{E} [m_n^4(\tau)]$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$?

20. What are the limits of $n \mathbb{E} [(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \tilde{\gamma}_n(h))^2]$ and $n \mathbb{E} [(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2]$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$?

Answers

Solution of Exercise 1 1.

- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.
- 6.
- 7.
- 8.
- 9.

Solution of Exercise 2 10. By Cauchy-Schwartz inequality, we have $|\alpha| \leq 1$. The mean of (X, Y) is $(0, 0)$ and its covariance matrix is $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & \alpha \\ \alpha & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

11. We have for $Y \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 1)$, $\mathbb{E}[Y^3] = \mathbb{E}[Y] = 0$ and $\mathbb{E}[Y^4] = 3$. The formulas follow.
12. We have $\hat{X} = \alpha Y$ since it belongs to $\text{Span}(Y)$ and satisfies the orthogonality condition $\mathbb{E}[(X - \hat{X})Y] = \text{Cov}(X - \hat{X}, Y) = 0$. Since ϵ and Y are jointly Gaussian and uncorrelated, they are independent.

Using that ϵ and Y are independent and the previous questions, we have

$$\text{Cov}(X^2, Y^2) = \text{Cov}((\alpha Y)^2 + \epsilon^2 + 2\alpha\epsilon Y, Y^2) = 2\alpha^2 + 0 + 2\alpha\text{Cov}(\epsilon Y, Y^2).$$

Since ϵ and Y are independent and centered, $\text{Cov}(\epsilon Y, Y^2) = \mathbb{E}[\epsilon Y^3] - 0 = \mathbb{E}[\epsilon]\mathbb{E}[Y^3] = 0$ and we get the result.

13. We can write $Z_1 = \sigma_1 X$ and $Z_2 = \sigma_2 Y$ with X and Y as previously and $\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2) = \sigma_1 \sigma_2 \alpha$. The bilinearity of covariance and the result of the previous question implies

$$\text{Cov}(Z_1^2, Z_2^2) = \sigma_1^2 \sigma_2^2 \text{Cov}(X^2, Y^2) = 2(\sigma_1 \sigma_2 \alpha)^2.$$

Hence the result.

14. We write $Z_1 Z_3$ and $Z_2 Z_4$ using the hinted formula and get that

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Cov}(Z_1 Z_3, Z_2 Z_4) &= \frac{1}{16} \text{Cov}((Z_1 + Z_3)^2 - (Z_1 - Z_3)^2, (Z_2 + Z_4)^2 - (Z_2 - Z_4)^2) \\
&= \frac{1}{16} [\text{Cov}((Z_1 + Z_3)^2, (Z_2 + Z_4)^2) - \text{Cov}((Z_1 - Z_3)^2, (Z_2 + Z_4)^2) \\
&\quad - \text{Cov}((Z_1 + Z_3)^2, (Z_2 - Z_4)^2) + \text{Cov}((Z_1 - Z_3)^2, (Z_2 - Z_4)^2)] \\
&= \frac{1}{8} [\text{Cov}^2(Z_1 + Z_3, Z_2 + Z_4) - \text{Cov}^2(Z_1 - Z_3, Z_2 + Z_4) \\
&\quad - \text{Cov}^2(Z_1 + Z_3, Z_2 - Z_4) + \text{Cov}^2(Z_1 - Z_3, Z_2 - Z_4)] \\
&= \frac{1}{8} [(\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 + Z_4) + \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 + Z_4))^2 \\
&\quad - (\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 + Z_4) - \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 + Z_4))^2 \\
&\quad - (\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 - Z_4) + \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 - Z_4))^2 \\
&\quad + (\text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 - Z_4) - \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 - Z_4))^2] \\
&= \frac{1}{8} [4 \text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 + Z_4) \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 + Z_4) \\
&\quad - 4 \text{Cov}(Z_1, Z_2 - Z_4) \text{Cov}(Z_3, Z_2 - Z_4)] .
\end{aligned}$$

After developing the covariances with respect to their second arguments and some simplifications, we get the formula that we are looking for.

15. We have, for all $h \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\mathbb{E}[\tilde{\gamma}_n(h)] = (1 - |h|/n)_+ \gamma(h)$ so

$$b(h) = [(1 - |h|/n)_+ - 1] \gamma(h) .$$

16. Using that Z is a Gaussian process and Question 14, we get, for all $h \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Var}(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h)) &= \frac{1}{n^2} \sum_{t, t'=1}^{n-|h|} \text{Cov}(Z_t Z_{t+|h|}, Z_{t'} Z_{t'+|h|}) \\
&= \frac{1}{n^2} \sum_{t, t'=1}^{n-|h|} (\gamma^2(t - t') + \gamma(t - t' - |h|) \gamma(t - t' + |h|)) \\
&= \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (1 - (|h| + |k|)/n)_+ (\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k - |h|) \gamma(k + |h|)) ,
\end{aligned}$$

where we set $k = t - t'$.

17. Applying the previous questions, we have for all $h \in \mathbb{Z}$,

$$\begin{aligned}
n \mathbb{E}[(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2] &= n b^2(h) + n \text{Var}(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h)) \\
&= n [(1 - |h|/n)_+ - 1]^2 \gamma^2(h) \\
&\quad + \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (1 - (|h| + |k|)/n)_+ (\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k - |h|) \gamma(k + |h|)) .
\end{aligned}$$

For n large enough, we have $n [(1 - |h|/n)_+ - 1]^2 = h^2/n$ which tends to zero as $n \rightarrow \infty$. On the other hand, we have

$$\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma^2(k) < \infty \quad \text{and so} \quad \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} |\gamma(k - |h|)\gamma(k + |h|)| < \infty.$$

Hence by dominated convergence, we get

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (1 - (|h| + |k|)/n)_+ (\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k - |h|)\gamma(k + |h|)) \\ = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (1 - (|h| + |k|)/n)_+ (\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k - |h|)\gamma(k + |h|)) \\ = \sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} (\gamma^2(k) + \gamma(k - |h|)\gamma(k + |h|)). \end{aligned}$$

This is our limit $\ell(h)$ of $n\mathbb{E} [(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2]$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$.

By the Parseval and Plancherel identities, we have

$$\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma^2(k) = 2\pi \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f^2(\lambda) d\lambda$$

and

$$\sum_{k \in \mathbb{Z}} \gamma(k - |h|)\gamma(k + |h|) = 2\pi \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f^2(\lambda) e^{2i|h|\lambda} d\lambda = 2\pi \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f^2(\lambda) \cos(2|h|\lambda) d\lambda$$

(by symmetry of f). Hence we get

$$\ell(h) = 2\pi \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} f^2(\lambda) (1 + \cos(2|h|\lambda)) d\lambda.$$

18. Take $n > 2|h|$. Observing that $U_t - \hat{\mu}_n = Z_t - m_n(0)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\gamma}_n(h) &= \frac{1}{n} \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} (Z_t - m_n(0)) (Z_{t+|h|} - m_n(0)) \\ &= \tilde{\gamma}_n(h) + (1 - |h|/n) m_n^2(0) - \frac{m_n(0)}{n} \left(\sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_t + \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_{t+|h|} \right). \end{aligned}$$

It suffices now to observe that for $n > 2|h|$, we have

$$\sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_t + \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_{t+|h|} = \sum_{t=1}^{n-|h|} Z_t + \sum_{t=1+|h|}^n Z_t = \sum_{t=1}^n Z_t + \sum_{t=1+|h|}^{n-|h|} Z_t.$$

We get that

$$\hat{\gamma}_n(h) = \tilde{\gamma}_n(h) + (1 - |h|/n) m_n^2(0) - m_n(0) [m_n(0) + m_n(|h|)].$$

19. $m_n(\tau)$ is a centered Gaussian variable with variance

$$n^{-2} \sum_{k, k'=1+\tau}^{n-\tau} \gamma(k-k') \leq n^{-1} \sum_k |\gamma(k)| = O(n^{-1}) .$$

Hence its moment of order 4 is $O(n^{-2})$ as $n \rightarrow \infty$.

20. Let $h \in \mathbb{Z}$. From the two previous questions and the Minkowski's inequality, we have that, for $n > 2|h|$,

$$\begin{aligned} \left(\mathbb{E} \left[(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \tilde{\gamma}_n(h))^2 \right] \right)^{1/2} &\leq 2 \left(\mathbb{E} \left[(m_n(0))^4 \right] \right)^{1/2} + \left(\mathbb{E} \left[(m_n(0)m_n(|h|))^2 \right] \right)^{1/2} \\ &= O(n^{-1}) , \end{aligned}$$

where we also used that $\mathbb{E} \left[(m_n(0)m_n(|h|))^2 \right] \leq \left(\mathbb{E} \left[(m_n(0))^4 \right] \right)^{1/2} \left(\mathbb{E} \left[(m_n(|h|))^4 \right] \right)^{1/2}$. We thus get

$$n \mathbb{E} \left[(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \tilde{\gamma}_n(h))^2 \right] = O(n^{-1}) .$$

Now, using again the Minkowski's inequality, we have

$$\left| \left(n \mathbb{E} \left[(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2 \right] \right)^{1/2} - \left(n \mathbb{E} \left[(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2 \right] \right)^{1/2} \right| \leq \left(n \mathbb{E} \left[(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \tilde{\gamma}_n(h))^2 \right] \right)^{1/2} = O(n^{-1/2}) .$$

Hence $n \mathbb{E} \left[(\hat{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2 \right]$ and $\mathbb{E} \left[(\tilde{\gamma}_n(h) - \gamma(h))^2 \right]$ have the same limit as $n \rightarrow \infty$, that is, $\ell(h)$.